

Ashley Riley

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About Me

Senior QA/Testing professional, 16 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: Docker, Cypress, Playwright.

Education and Training

Bachelor, Software Engineering

Lakeshore University | 2005 – 2008

Experience

Senior QA Engineer, SAP

Mar 2020 – Present | South Theresa (Hybrid)

- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 8% to 90%.
- Owned release sign-off for 8 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in CI/CD, catching defects staging had missed.
- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 30 hours to 5 minutes through parallelisation.
- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.

QA Engineer, Atlassian

Dec 2012 – Nov 2019 | Jessicafurt (Remote)

- Built a performance harness in Playwright simulating 15k concurrent users.
- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.
- Mentored 40 manual testers into automation roles.
- Established test data management practices later adopted by 10 teams.

QA Analyst, Salesforce

Feb 2011 – Oct 2012 | Lyonsport (Remote (UK))

- Integrated automated checks into the Docker pipeline, blocking 5 faulty releases.
- Automated 5 regression suites with CI/CD, cutting the manual test cycle by 22%.
- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.

SDET, Beacon Interactive

Sep 2009 – Jan 2011 | Millerton (Hybrid)

- Reduced escaped defects by 25% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- Drove accessibility coverage from 30% to 94% of core journeys.
- Took over an unowned service, documented it and brought it back under SLO.

Technical Skills

Docker — Expert

Cypress — Expert

Playwright — Advanced

Python — Expert

JavaScript — Proficient

CI/CD — Expert

GitHub Actions — Working knowledge

Selenium — Expert

Git — Intermediate

Ansible — Expert

Redshift — Working knowledge

SQL — Expert

Go — Expert

Open Source

Conference talk

Spoke on Ansible in production at a regional meetup, ~70 attendees.

Recipe search engine

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using Cypress; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

Licences & Certifications

Tableau Desktop Specialist — Tableau, 2026

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2024

Research Output

"Measuring the cost of technical debt in delivery throughput" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2010.

Awards

Dean's List, 2025

References available upon request.